

ZAYNEB CHERIF

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EDUCATION

Columbia University — B.A. Computer Science Expected May 2028
Relevant Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, Linear Algebra, AI in Context

University of Oxford Aug 2026
AI and Machine Learning Summer Program

EXPERIENCE

OpenAI Jun – Aug 2026
AI Model Trainer, Codex

- Improved Codex reliability by designing 50+ adversarial evaluations targeting code correctness and reasoning
- Built evaluation workflows to track behavioral regressions and recurring failure patterns across prompt configurations.

MIT-Incubated Stealth Startup Jun 2026 – Aug 2026
Software Engineering Intern

- Built an end-to-end AI document platform with a frontend and FastAPI backend supporting 4 file formats, semantic search, and cited responses.
- Engineered a 4-agent system integrating Gmail, document retrieval, fact-checking, and human-approved tool execution.

IBM Research Sep 2023 – May 2024
AI Analytics Researcher

- Benchmarked ResNet and U-Net across 6 analog AI hardware configurations, surfacing accuracy-performance tradeoffs
- Co-authored 2 peer-reviewed papers (ICLR 2024 Notable, IJCAI 2024) on deep learning for analog in-memory computing.

New York University Oct – Dec 2025
Data Analytics Research Intern

- Analyzed 75+ HMXB time series using Python/scikit-learn pipelines to estimate orbital periods, frequencies, and confidence scores.
- Reviewed 150+ research papers to compile orbital and stellar parameters for Magellanic Cloud HMXBs.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, TypeScript
Frameworks & Tools: React, Next.js, Node.js, FastAPI, Git/GitHub
ML & Data: PyTorch, scikit-learn, Pandas, RAG, LLM APIs, Model Evaluation

PROJECTS

Are.na Visualizer 2026
TypeScript · Next.js · React · Are.na API

- Built an interactive visualization system that transforms Are.na channel data into Canvas, Grid, and Disks views.
- Designed reusable frontend components and state management across three visualization modes.

Pfizer Enterprise Document Intelligence 2026
Python · FastAPI · RAG · Vector Search · OCR

- Built an end-to-end document intelligence pipeline combining OCR, page-level routing, and cited RAG responses
- Benchmarked 3 OCR engines and multiple retrieval configurations to improve extraction from noisy documents

Wildfire Risk Modeling — AI Akhawayn University 2026
Python · Pandas · Geospatial Data · Machine Learning

- Built an end-to-end data pipeline to validate and preprocess 187K wildfire observations across 280 features, with leakage-safe imputation and feature engineering.

Awards: IEEE WISC Scholar 2026 · ICLR 2024 Notable Paper · Genius Olympiad Finalist · WESEF Finalist